“Look, look!” Paulette ran up the slope nearly tripping over herself, weighed down by the objects clinking against the side of the basket. “I did what you said. Made the list and see—nothing in the basket is in your sketchbook.”

“Well done.” Léa clapped her hands.

“I wrote everything down—do you want to see my list?” Paulette asked, excitedly. “Or are we going to do the drawing first? Can I help you put things on the table?”

Rose wanted to draw even if her fingers were sore from gripping the cutters all day. “Let’s see what you’ve collected for me.”

Paulette jumped up, excitement rippling from her small body. She pulled out a paper from the basket and handed it to Léa. “With Maman’s help, I checked all the spelling.”

“Bravo.” Léa bent down, took the paper and kissed her on the cheek. “I will look these over carefully.” Then her gaze shifted to her sister, who was removing a silver platter from the basket, turning it one way and another to catch the falling sunlight. “Did your Maman agree that you could take this?” she asked, a note of worry in her voice.

Paulette nodded. “She said every still life has a silver platter.”

Rose, remembering the paintings in the book, smiled. “Your mother is a wise woman.”

“Can you teach me how to draw?” Paulette suddenly asked, her eyes flashed with joy.

Rose looked at her, nonplussed. “I’ve never taught—”

“Please, please—”

“Paulette,” her mother said, coming out from the house. “Are you pestering Rose again?”

“I want to draw like Rose. She can teach me.”

Virginie clapped her hands. “Oh, I see.”

“You want to, don’t you?” Paulette pleaded.

“Of course,” Rose said. “I just don’t know how.”

Virginie smiled. “Just tell her what you do, that might be enough.”

“Please. I promise to be good,” Paulette said.

“All right, we can try. Let’s start by bringing the basket inside and arranging the items on a table until we get the right composition.”

“What’s a composition?” Paulette asked, jumping up and reaching for